



After-Action Review

UNDP response to the 2022 Pakistan floods

**Julian Murray Consulting
21 December 2023**



U N

D P

Table of contents

- 1. Executive Summary
- 9. Context
- 15. Leadership
- 16. External coordination
- 25. SURGE and response
- 29. Communications
- 31. Resource mobilisation for UNDP
- 37. UNDP programming
- 42. Gender Equality
- 44. Operations
- 46. Recommendations
- 53. Annexes



U N
D P

Acknowledgements

We would like to thank the Crisis Bureau team who facilitated the review, researched and provided background documents, and provided feedback on the inception and final reports: Rebecca Reynolds, Archana Aryal and Ola Karakra. Tilini Subhoda Kuruppu Arachchige assisted with a full revision of the deployee list.

UNDP staff and deployees across the globe generously gave their time and provided valuable insights through remote interviews. Most of all, we offer our sincere thanks to the small and mighty team in the country office, notably Amir Goraya, Hamza Hasan, Shiraz Shah and Syeda Zainab, for their support with arranging the field mission, as well as its many and frequently-changing appointments.



Acronyms

4RF	Resilient Recovery, Rehabilitation and Reconstruction Framework for Pakistan
AAR	After-Action Review
ARR	Assistant Resident Representative
ACC LAB	Accelerator Lab
BERA	Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy
BMS	Bureau for Management Support
BRH	Bangkok Regional Hub
CB	Crisis Bureau
CD	Country Director
CMST	Crisis Management Support Team
CPRU	Crisis Prevention and Recovery Unit
CSMT	Country Support Management Team
CO	Country Office
CPD	Country Program Document
DRR	Deputy Resident Representative
EAD	Economic Affairs Division
ER	Early Recovery
ERA	Early Recovery Advisor
FRP	Floods Recovery Programme
GE	Gender Equality
GoP	Government of Pakistan
HC	Humanitarian Coordinator
HCT	Humanitarian Country Team
HRP	Humanitarian Response Plan
IPSG	International Partners Support Group
IRP	Islamic Relief Pakistan
KPK	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
MAGP	Merged Areas Governance Project
MSU	Management Support Unit
NDMA	National Disaster Management Authority
OCHA	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
PDNA	Post Disaster Needs Assessment
RBAP	Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific
RC	UN Resident Coordinator
RECCU	Recovery, Environment, and Climate Change Unit
RR	Resident Representative
SOPs	Standard Operating Procedures
TF	Taraqee Foundation



Caveats

This is an After-Action Review, not an evaluation. It aims to provide real-time feedback from participants after an event with an emphasis upon learning, and not to be an assessment of performance and results with an emphasis on accountability. It is also intended for internal use - not for general publication.

These findings are the result of interviews with UNDP staff and deployees, as well as an extensive review of documents, a short online survey, supplemented by discussions with donors, government authorities at federal and provincial levels, UN entities (RC and OCHA) and civil society partners.

Not all staff had the same perspectives or shared the same opinions, and some interviewees were only involved for a limited period of time. These findings try to fairly reflect the prevailing view, rather than a consensus.

Feedback was provided to country management at the conclusion of the country visit. While it is more common for an AAR to analyse a unique event, and for its lessons to therefore be more useful to the Crisis and Regional Bureaux, in this instance the CO response is still building up, and the likelihood of a repeat event is considered to be high. As a result, this AAR has more recommendations for the attention of the CO than is usually the case, including a few suggestions that go beyond the strict limits of the crisis response. There is also a separate analysis of the extent to which UNDP receives funding in response to humanitarian appeals

Recommendations benefited from a mini-workshop involving key staff from the CB and the CO, with written inputs from RBAP.

Executive Summary

What went well

- PDNA, Govt recovery plan, donor conference
- UNDP support for Government
- Crisis Board
- First responders
- SURGE plan
- ExpRes roster
- Communications



What could be improved

- Humanitarian literacy and engagement with HCT
- More strategic use of TRAC 1.1.3 program funding
- Resource-mobilisation for UNDP
- SURGE coordination in-country
- Construction procurement
- Innovation, including use of ACC LAB
- Connection to the new CPD
- Gender equality

Key Recommendations

To CO:

- Prepare now for next time
- Prepare and train up a crisis response team
- Pilot “crisis modifiers”
- Build a roster of national experts
- Contingency planning
- Use other agency LTAs more

To CB:

- Engage more on Anticipatory Action
- Provide crisis training to senior staff
- Support CO preparedness
- Inform RBs and COs of current guidelines
- Support the piloting of “crisis modifiers” (more on slide 37)
- Improve deployee continuity and handover

To Regional Bureaux

- Address procurement and operations bottlenecks in coordination with BMS
- Pilot “crisis modifiers”
- Improve contingency planning
- Foster a culture shift from overcompliance to risk-informed decision-making

To BMS

- Fix a critical issue in the construction policy



Big picture

UNDP Pakistan's support for the needs assessment, the Government recovery plan and the donor conference were key enablers for Pakistan's Government-led recovery.

Possibly this would not have come together without UNDP's support.

Engaging early and deep with Government was the right strategy, even to the detriment of UNDP's own resource mobilisation. UNDP has ended up with very strong relationships, and even though several stakeholders believe that the CO should have made greater effort at resource mobilisation from the IFIs and the bilateral donors, it is not likely that UNDP would have raised substantial resources in the current donor environment in Pakistan.

But this revealed two dilemmas for UNDP. Dilemma #1: UNDP does the right thing working with and for Government, but this does not necessarily lead to funding of UNDP's recovery programmes.

Dilemma #2: work to build resilience also falls short in generating support for UNDP's recovery efforts"

Looking ahead, the Pakistan CO should acknowledge that floods were not a swiftly unfolding disaster, and earlier involvement was necessary. Recognizing that these events are not unique, the CO can now implement various measures to enhance preparedness for future occurrences.

UNDP globally struggles to respond quickly. To remain effective in the rapid response space, the organisation needs systems that enable rapid mobilisation of resources and projects; a procurement and audit culture that rewards strategic risk management over process and compliance; and greater ability to work across heavy, siloed programmes.

Possible strategic way forwards: UNDP needs to pay more attention to anticipation and prevention – anticipatory action might be the new location of the nexus.



What went well

Crisis Board processes worked well: quick and effective cross-organisation mobilisation and support, SURGE deployments, quick release of funding, ongoing support from Crisis Bureau.

Quick and quality first responder team, immediately followed by rapid deployment of additional staff for the SURGE mission. As observed in previous AARs: deploying experienced staff is much quicker, more effective and more integrated than deploying external experts on IC contracts.

Strong SURGE plan, well adapted to national context largely thanks to Pakistani team-members.

ExpRes roster worked extremely well. The large mobilisation of Pakistani nationals had pros and cons: mostly pros - but COs need to be more conscious of the cons in order to mitigate in future.

The stream of support for Government planning and resource mobilisation (PDNA – 4RF – Donor Conference – IPSG) was highlighted by all stakeholder groups as outstanding and demonstrating UNDP's comparative advantage.

Excellent partnerships with Government at federal and provincial levels (support for sub-national needs assessments, plans and donor meetings were highly appreciated by provincial authorities, and UNDP Baluchistan sub-office was valued by the UN system as the convenor for local humanitarian coordination).

Local civil society partners see UNDP as a preferred donor.

Relatively few operations bottlenecks, and Delivery Lab is providing valuable support post-crisis.

Communications were strong at all levels. UNDP's work was sufficiently covered by media, major news outlets carried the recovery story, and UNDP was well-profiled for donors and Government. However, this did not translate into resource-mobilisation for new UNDP programming.



What could have been better

The CO had low levels of awareness on the humanitarian architecture, limited pre crisis engagement with the HCT and limited understanding of UNDP's crisis response mechanisms, including the nature and extent of support available from the Crisis Bureau, fast-track operational flexibilities, and pre-existing tripartite PDNA arrangements.

More strategic use could have been made of the \$ 500K TRAC 1.1.3 funding for programatic response . The initial activities implemented by UNDP's local NGO partners were in themselves excellent, but several of the piloted elements (cash-for-work, cash for small enterprise, shelter construction) were not scaled up in the follow-on project with Japan. The rather promising follow-on projects funded by China were built on the experience of prior Chinese-funded projects, rather than the two NGO pilots. What the pilots did achieve, was establish credibility with the provincial Governments that UNDP is a reliable partner.

UNDP could have done better at resource-mobilisation, although in all fairness the bilateral donor environment was not conducive for recovery or for UNDP.

Clarity of roles for the recovery. Key roles were not always well defined (between the RR, DRR, ARR and SURGE coordinator), and it was often unclear who was leading what within the office, which is characterized by strong, heavy, siloed programming units that have little history of cross-unit collaboration. In the end, the SURGE employees felt they spoke mainly to each other and not to CO colleagues.

Corporate guidelines for construction are not proving suitable for community-led small-scale infrastructure, a model widely adopted in the Pakistan response and initially piloted by UNDP. Swift adaptation of guidelines is essential for seamless project execution.

Little evidence of innovation: business as usual in the office mobilisation (silos with no multi-function task team), and in the activities (everyone was doing more of what they know, classic recovery package of livelihoods, housing and small-scale infrastructure with little attention to resilience – repeat of 2010 flood package). Minimal engagement with the Accelerator Lab, no digital engagement or innovative thinking.

Flood Recovery Program and recovery projects are unconnected to the recently-approved Pakistan CPD, probably because the SURGE team was unaware of the new CO framework – resulting in a missed opportunity and maybe a risk of misalignment downstream.



U N
D P

Context



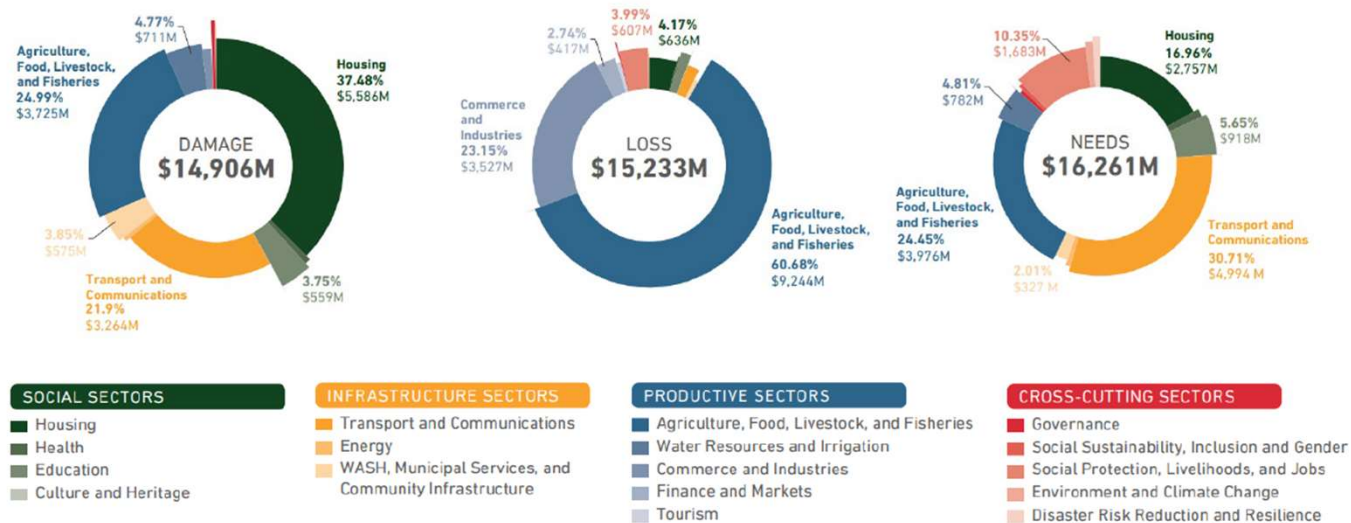


U N

D P

“Between June and August 2022, torrential rains and a combination of riverine, urban, and flash flooding led to an unprecedented disaster in Pakistan. At the height of the flooding, one-third of the country was under water, 33 million people were affected, and nearly 8 million people reportedly displaced. The floods took the lives of more than 1,700 people, one-third of whom were children. More than half of all the districts in the country were declared as “calamity-hit” with the majority of those affected located in the provinces of Sindh, Balochistan, and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.” – Resilient Recovery, Rehabilitation and Reconstruction Framework for Pakistan (4RF)

Damage: \$14.91 B - Loss: \$15.23 B – Needs: \$16.26B



Source: PDNA



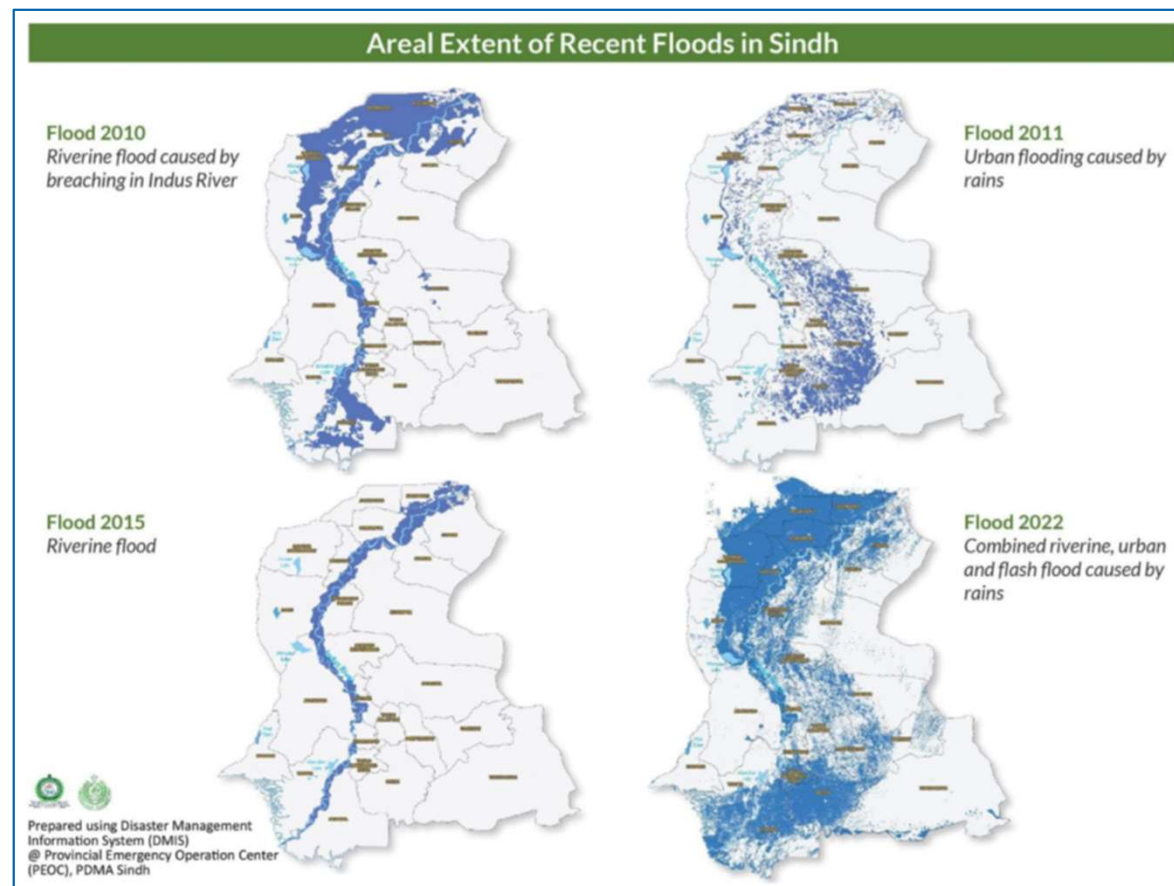
UN
DP

Slow-onset disaster without a single trigger event.

Government and UN system slow to appreciate the extent of the floods, and slow to mobilise.

Sense of crisis amplified by social media, and full response started with OCHA appeal on 30 August 2022.

Eventually, more extensive and persistent floods than 2010, affecting mostly Sindh and Baluchistan.



Source: PDNA

Some key factors underlying the international response:

- (1) Difficult bilateral donor environment** (overall funding constraints and ambiguous relationship with Government of Pakistan especially since the Afghanistan crisis)
- (2) Strong and demanding Government** (sometimes inconsistent due to differing priorities of ministries, against a backdrop of domestic political crisis)
- (3) COP 27 at the same time as the floods, framed this as a climate disaster**
- (4) Competing global priorities** (responding to the Ukraine war, and Feb 2023 earthquake in Turkey and Syria)



Context of UNDP Pakistan Country Office

Strong and well-established CO: 318 positions, and ROAR Quality Score (2020) in UNDP's top 7 performers.

Delivery of \$55-70M/year at an average delivery rate of 87%.

New Country Program Document (CPD) drafted just before the floods for 2023-2027 (endorsed at the Aug 2022 Executive Board) with four outcomes, including a bold, new outcome 4 on Gender Equality that is largely unfunded and yet unplanned. While the CPD does not make explicit reference to recovery, it embodies concepts and goals for the CO that also relate to recovery.

3 programme pillars for Democratic Governance, Environment and Climate Change, and Crisis Prevention and Recovery (CPRU), supported by Development Policy Unit, Management Support Unit (MSU), Accelerator Lab (ACC LAB), Communications and several Operations Units.

Limited reorganization under way at the time of the floods, notably creating the Recovery, Environment and Climate Change unit (RECCU) at the end of October 2022, absorbing some of the functions of the CPRU.

Geographic emphasis on Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KPK) and Baluchistan, with limited presence in Sindh – the province most affected by the floods. This limited opportunities to pivot existing projects to flood response.

Described by people surveyed and interviewed as being reliable but not agile.

Strong program units and weak integration of teams responsible for policy, gender and innovation

Most staff interviewed felt that the programme units had strong program momentum and deep specialization. This has its benefits for focus and performance, but also can result in units being somewhat isolated from each other: many staff referred to silos, rendering cross-unit collaboration on horizontal initiatives such as flood response more difficult. The Policy Unit feels that they could add more value but were not consulted sufficiently and early enough.

Responsibility for Gender Equality (GE) was divided between five different teams: Governance (with much of the GE programming especially in the domains of rights and law), MSU (on gender reporting), the Gender Advisor (reporting to the DRR and focused mainly on GE in projects), and the ACC LAB (reporting to the RR) which, together with the Policy Unit, coordinated a Portfolio Initiation Framework for the CPD's ambitious outcome 4 on gender equality. Gender-related information was reportedly not always shared between the teams, not everyone is invited to relevant discussions, and it is not always clear if everyone is working on the same GE plan. There is also no overall GE strategy (yet – currently in draft).

As in Lebanon, the Accelerator Lab did not feel sufficiently connected to, or consulted by the main program units.



Timeline of UNDP response to 2022 floods

External events

UNDP internal events

Key Deployments

Key UNDP activities

14 June 2022	Seasonal monsoon season begins (NDMA)
July 2022	Slow build of crisis as floods continue without catastrophic events (OCHA reg bulletins)
22 July 2022	First emergency response plan issued (IFRCs)
24 July 2022	First OCHA situation report
29 July 2022	Islamic Relief Pakistan issues Emergency Response Plan (UKP 30M)
August	Acceleration in crisis build-up as floods continue
24 Aug 2022	Generalised floods extend to the plains of Pakistan
29 Aug 2022	Govt of Pakistan (EAD) asks UNDP to conduct a PDNA
30 Aug 2022	OCHA issues Flood Response Plan (USD 160M)
1 Sept 2022	First UNDP crisis responder: Recovery Advisor deployed
2 Sept 2022	UNDP Crisis Board meeting #1
6 Sept 2022	UNDP Project Initiation Plan approved by UNDP CO (USD 18M)
7 Sept 2022	UNDP Exigency memo signed by RBAP
9-10 Sept 2022	UNSG Guterres visit to Pakistan
12 Sept 2022	CMST meeting #1
15 Sept 2022	PDNA mission starts (ends 14 Oct)
20 Sept 2022	UNDP SURGE mission starts (ends 30 Sept)
4 Oct 2022	OCHA issues revised Flood Response Plan (USD 816M)
4 Oct 2022	Multi-sector Rapid Needs Assessment (KPK, Punjab, Sindh) released
4 Oct 2022	UNDP signed first SURGE-funded project agreement with Taraqee Foundation
6 Oct 2022	UNDP SURGE response plan submitted
11 Oct 2022	UNDP Crisis Board meeting #2
17 Oct 2022	UNDP releases UNDP's Flood Recovery Programme Vision
18 Oct 2022	Baluchistan Rapid Needs Assessment released
28 Oct 2022	PDNA released
Nov 2022	Govt of KPK releases Flood Response Plan 2022 (with UNDP MAGP project support)
6-18 Nov 2023	COP27 in Egypt: Pakistan frames the floods as a climate-induced emergency
18 Nov 2022	UNDP signs second SURGE-funded project agreement with Islamic Relief Pakistan
Dec 2022	Govt of Sindh releases Strategic Policy for Floods response 2022
16 Dec 2022	UNDP launches UNDP Flood Recovery Programme (FRP) (USD 90M)
16 Dec 2022	LPAC meeting approves UNDP PRODOC for UNDP FRP
22 Dec 2022	PDNA Supplementary Report issued
early Jan 2023	4RF summary released (for the donor conference)
9 Jan 2023	Geneva Conference on Climate Resilient Pakistan
8 Feb 2023	Sindh conference "Resilient Sindh: From Pledges to Reconstruction"
30 March 2023	First meeting of the International Partners Support Group (IPSG)
27 April 2023	PRODOC for UNDP FRP signed by UNDP RBAP and RR
25 May 2023	Second meeting of the International Partners Support Group
24 July 2023	Third meeting of the International Partners Support Group



U N

D P

Leadership, decision-making and internal coordination

Readiness?

Neither the CO nor the entire UN system had suitable early warning and quick mobilisation systems in place. The CO has many competent staff but they were heads-down in large portfolios – and also dealing with several compounding crises already (political crisis, economic crisis, COVID), and did not see the warning signs.

Crisis Board: did everything it was expected to do

Crisis Board met early, was decisive, and did everything according to the SOPs. Some participants saw the Crisis Board as “business as usual” after handling the crises in Afghanistan and Ukraine. This raises the question: is the Crisis Board mechanism used because it is adding real value and providing special powers, or because it is a way to work around systemic weaknesses (for example, adding staff when CO recruitment is bottlenecked)?

SURGE mission: high quality, relevant and comprehensive SURGE plan

A **strong team was deployed to the field very quickly**, and deployment was innovative in that it was led by the Regional Bureau (RBAP) and contained several international staff of Pakistani origin.

Country Office: perceived from the outside as better coordinated than it looks from the inside

Initially, as the disaster was on a slow build, the CO seemed hesitant about mounting a major response effort. After the CO was persuaded by Crisis Bureau and RBAP staff to engage, then flood response became the main priority of CO leadership.

Externally (Government and donors) the CO was seen as organised, coherent and well-led. However, internally, it was not always clear who was in charge of the response (RR, DRR, ARR/RECCU or the senior SURGE deployee), and this “lack of a bird’s eye view” left some blind spots. In particular, despite the convening of periodic Floods Task Force meetings, there was **no clear programming and resource-mobilisation strategy** (see later discussion). Part of the problem stemmed from the strength of the silos, but also there were unclear reporting relationships of the SURGE deployees, not helped by the unfortunate timing (planned and under way before the floods) of the transition of functions from the CPRU to the RECCU. Both the Policy Unit and the ACC LAB felt that they could have been involved earlier at the conceptual stage, but were not invited into the discussion.

In the end, the flood response was not linked to the regular CO programs but became a new pillar (silo) under the newly-formed RECCU.

Geneva conference: widely regarded as a leadership and coordination high point

The real test of leadership, decision-making and internal coordination came 3-5 months later with the organisation of the Geneva Donor Conference. This was done very well (see later discussion).



External coordination: humanitarian phase

UNDP at the humanitarian moment:

Neither OCHA nor the rest of the UN system were ready for the 2022 floods. Pakistan floods were not a fast-moving disaster – the system should have got involved earlier. The system-wide takeaway is that **the UN needs to pay more attention to anticipation and prevention.**

At the time of the floods, OCHA's in-country presence had been reduced to a skeleton crew: there was an HRP 2021-2022 (with a focus on Afghans, COVID 19 and people displaced by natural disasters including previous floods), and the HCT was meeting occasionally, although UNDP was not actively engaged.

When the HCT was energized around the floods and started preparing an appeal, UNDP asked for a seat at the table but were **explicitly requested by the RC/HC to stand aside** and prepare for a later recovery.

UNDP staff in Sub-offices were recognised for their effective coordination of humanitarian action at local level.

UNDP and humanitarian funding: the CO made the right decision not to seek humanitarian funding

Some staff in RBAP (more than in the CO) felt that UNDP should have been more assertive in seeking a place in the HRP and in seeking humanitarian funding, perhaps even activating an early recovery cluster. The AAR enquiry confirmed that the **RC/HC and HCT members were not willing to allow UNDP any space**, and donors confirmed that it is **very unlikely that UNDP would have received humanitarian funding** if they had tried.

UNDP and humanitarian funding: the history of the past 10 years of UNDP receiving on-plan* funding

1. UNDP has received USD 1B of on-plan* humanitarian funding 2013-2022
2. All of the crises receiving > USD 10M over the 10 year period were protracted conflicts
3. 57% of this on-plan funding was for the Syrian crisis (3RP and Syria response)
4. By far the largest donor of on-plan funding is Japan, with 32% of the on-plan funding and 23% of the on-plan projects
5. In addition to Syria response, funding spiked in 2020 (DRC, COVID, Yemen) and 2022 (Afghanistan, Yemen, Ukraine)

Conclusions:

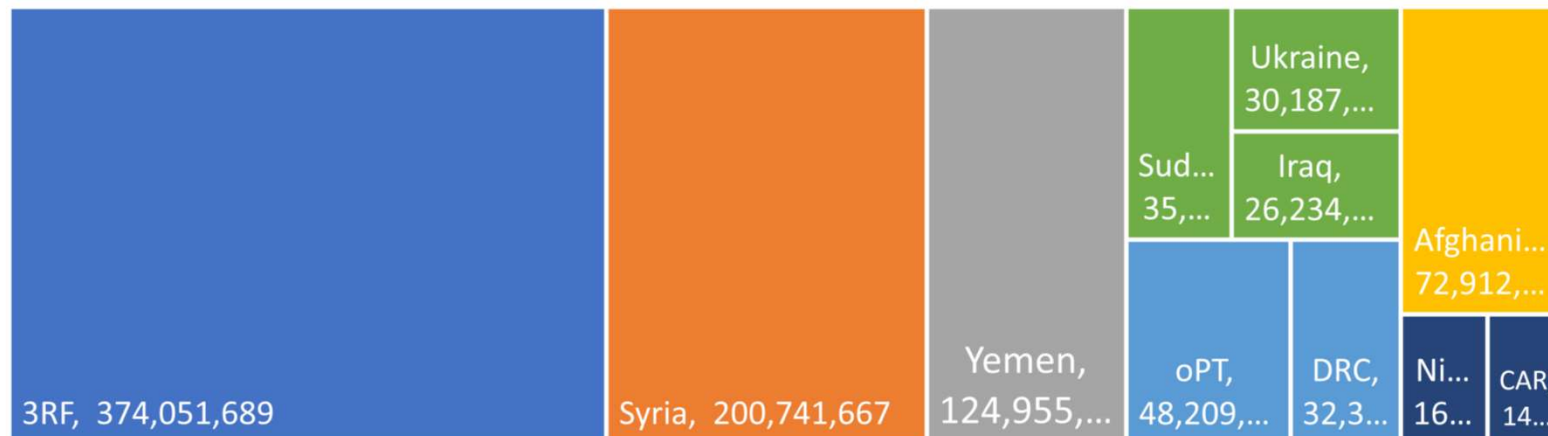
Anticipating limited humanitarian funding for UNDP in sudden-onset natural disasters, its resource mobilization efforts should be concentrated, prioritizing Japan, followed by the USA, Germany, and the UK.

* "on-plan" funding is funding requested through a Humanitarian Response Plan (HRP) and coded by the donor as a contribution to an HRP

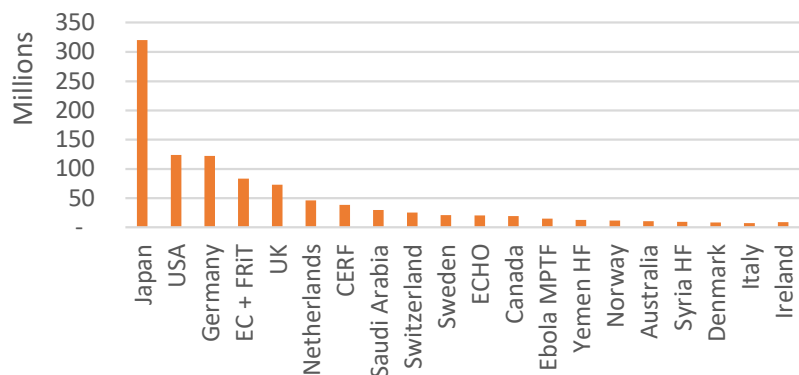


The history of the past 10 years of UNDP receiving on-plan funding

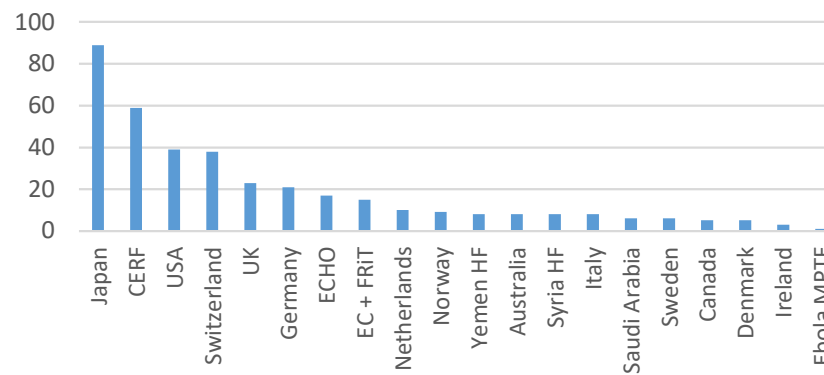
Where did UNDP receive > USD 10M on-plan in the last 10 years?



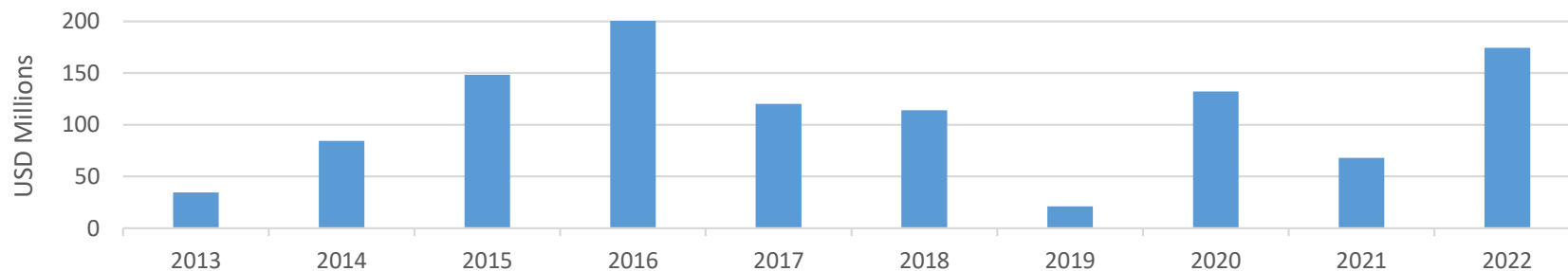
Which donors gave the most to UNDP?



Largest number of projects with UNDP?



Annual trends in on-plan funding to UNDP



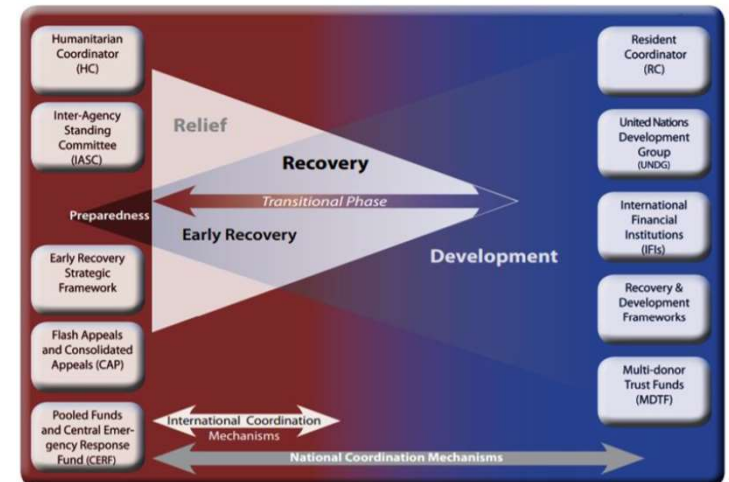


External coordination: humanitarian-development nexus

The Humanitarian-Development transition

The GoP wanted to minimise the (UN-managed) humanitarian phase and move as quickly as possible to (Government-managed) recovery – indeed the GoP's initial request for a PDNA was issued before the OCHA appeal was released. The RC supported the Government in this, discouraged a heavy mobilisation of international experts in favour of a more indigenous approach, and **actively discouraged the idea of an “early recovery” plan or period, or a “nexus”**, which might encumber a rapid humanitarian-development transition.

As a result, instead of a gradual phased and connected transition as characterised in the classic “early recovery” model of intersecting triangles shown above, an entirely separate recovery track was launched very early, and ran in parallel to the humanitarian track.



UN-led, humanitarian sectors framed by HRP

Two tracks overlap but unconnected

Government-led, development sectors framed by 4RF

UNDP's attempts to support the Humanitarian-Development transition

UNDP tried to support the transition in two ways. First, as part of the SURGE plan, and following the classic approach that is normally expected of UNDP in a sudden-onset emergency, UNDP fielded a dedicated Humanitarian-Development Nexus Advisor to support the RC with the planning of the transition. It is not clear if the RC requested or was even aware of this assignment, and in any event the advisor was not allowed to assume his planned responsibilities, never met the RC, and ended up repurposed to support the development of Joint Programs (while working quietly at a technical level with OCHA to support alignment of the revised HRP and the 4RF).

At the same time, another SURGE deployee attempted to join several humanitarian sector working groups relevant to UNDP's Flood Recovery Program, in order to encourage recovery-thinking and humanitarian programming that would join up with the recovery track. This deployee was disinvited from the food security/agriculture sector, but remained engaged in the WASH and Shelter sectors, adding significant value to the shelter sector in particular.



External coordination: PDNA

PDNA: a few initial bumps

The Government: Economic Affairs Division (EAD) initially asked UNDP to lead on the PDNA, since neither EAD (nor the CO) were aware of the tripartite agreement on PDNAs. As soon as World Bank, EU and ADB were brought in, there was some brief jostling between EAD and Planning, as well as between UNDP and the WB over mandates and sectors. Following an agreement, the work started promptly and intensely.

There were some understandable challenges of managing such a large team (80+) with such short deadlines, and some moments where UNDP and WB communicated directly with GoP without the other. There were expected pressures from the Government to deliver quickly and for the final tally to match initial estimates released by the Government, and one UNDP employee was not a good fit, antagonized the partners and was removed from the assignment.



PAKISTAN FLOODS 2022 Post-Disaster Needs Assessment

MAIN
REPORT



Ministry of Planning
Development &
Special Initiatives

PDNA: highly regarded by all stakeholders

UNDP fielded an A-Team of international and national experts, many drawn from the CO staff, and extraordinarily quickly.

UNDP was perceived to have effectively and efficiently coordinated the UN's expertise for the PDNA, stepping in when sister agencies faced challenges, ensuring a seamless response.

“cracking job” “tremendous job” “very helpful”

“really delivered” “mobilised quickly”

“first real example of donor coordination in 5 years”



UN
DP

External coordination: 4RF and provincial plans

4RF: a second huge effort from UNDP

Following through on the initial SURGE strategy of supporting the Government to plan the country's recovery, possibly to the detriment of efforts to mobilise resources for UNDP itself (see later discussion), UNDP allocated the bulk of its efforts in the October-December period to co-drafting the 4RF. Compared to the PDNA, in the 4RF, UNDP carried more of the weight, with less participation from other UN agencies.

4RF: another win for UNDP

The 4RF is strong, well-articulated and emphasises LNOB and social inclusion. It appears to be more people-centred than would be expected from the IFIs, suggesting significant value-added by UN partners and experts involved in the drafting.

The Framework is ambitious in scope, timing and resourcing – and is more likely to be used as a general guide, and as the basis for obtaining and allocating loan funding, than as a programming blueprint.

**RESILIENT RECOVERY,
REHABILITATION, AND
RECONSTRUCTION
FRAMEWORK
PAKISTAN (4RF)**



Government of Pakistan
Ministry of Planning,
Development and Special Initiatives
Islamabad

4RF: real benefit is in gathering attention and focus

As with the PDNA, the real value of the 4RF is not so much in the document itself, as in the requirement it imposes upon stakeholders to set priorities, coordinate, and get ready for a crowning event – in this case the Geneva conference. These landmark documents provide a concrete focal point for donor advocacy, and assurance that there is an agreed plan.

4RF: drafted to tight deadlines

There was strong pressure from the Government to complete the plan before COP27 (mid-Nov 2022): in the end the document itself was finished on the eve of the donor conference at the end of December. Pressure also to include in the 4RF additional needs of \$13.5B for resilience (water and transport infrastructure renewal) beyond the \$16.3B suggested in the PDNA as needed for recovery. UNDP managed to finesse this pressure by including an additional chapter on resilience, included in the report but not in the core framework.

Provincial plans:

In addition to the 4RF, UNDP staff assigned to work with provincial governments, and other staff embedded in provinces through other UNDP projects, supported the drafting of related recovery frameworks for KPK, Baluchistan and Sindh.



Internal and External coordination: Geneva conference

“All credit to UNDP”

Geneva conference: much bigger coordination challenge than it looked from the outside

Although a donor conference had been anticipated by the SURGE mission, the late decision on coordination responsibility, timing and location made this an all-consuming cross-organisation enterprise.

Challenges of coordinating with multiple UN and Government stakeholders

Coordination between UNDP and the EOSG was complex, considering the special requirements and protocols of a global SG-hosted event. In addition, UNDP coordination took place in three locations (New York, Islamabad and Geneva), the Government of Pakistan had several ministries involved and who did not coordinate well with each other, further complicated by efforts to liaise with the PRs of the donor countries in NY and Geneva and their Embassies in Pakistan. UNDP developed a “task team” approach of close, real-time, virtual collaboration across all the related UNDP offices, with clear delegated responsibilities, and decision-making centralized in a small senior team in NY.

Success factors

The Geneva conference is universally considered to have been a success. Even if the resource mobilisation for Pakistan’s recovery was less than ideal (see later discussion), all participants considered it to be a political and relationship success. Enabling factors include: a strong personal push from the Secretary-General, including the hosting of a lunch exclusively for Minister-level delegates (which boosted the level of participation); additional impetus from Pakistan’s parallel initiative at COP27 to frame the floods as a climate-induced disaster and Pakistan’s related work to create a climate loss and damage fund; behind-the-scenes support from Gulf States; the reframing of the conference around solidarity rather than pledges, together with the creation of a suite of side-meetings and events to remove pressure from the main meeting; the selection of Geneva as the location (with quality ready-built conference support systems); and the assignment by UNDP of an A-team of staff to support logistics and communications.



U N

D P

Geneva conference lessons learned

Interviews with several UNDP participants yielded the following list of lessons learned from the Geneva Conference:

1. Seek clear designation of UNDP as the coordinator from very early on
2. Determine the agenda with the host Government ASAP (avoid last-minute changes in agenda, presentations, speaking order etc.)
3. Decide venue and date as early as possible
4. Geneva is a terrific venue for a global event hosted by UNDP
5. Designate a senior official to be the lead for UNDP (better in NY not CO)
6. Create a small Task Team that is action-oriented
7. Check back to get lessons learned from previous conferences and get some key conference-experienced people on the team
8. Empower the Task Team to make on-the-spot decisions with minimum checking with senior management
9. Make the MS Teams technology work for you (scheduling, document-sharing, team chat etc)
10. Move the core staff in the organizing task team to the conference location
11. Designate one person exclusively to record all the pledges and research technical solutions to automate such data collection as much as possible in future



UN
DP

External coordination: donor conference follow-up

Sindh conference: “Resilient Sindh: From Pledges to Reconstruction”

One month after the main donor conference, a second conference was held in Sindh (8 February), very well attended by Ambassadors, Ministers and Heads of Agency. This second event was organised with considerable support from UNDP, and while it did not elicit any new pledges (indeed that was not its purpose), it provided a concrete statement of solidarity with the people of the province most affected by the floods and was much appreciated by the Provincial Government.



Chief Minister of Sindh addresses “Resilient Sindh” conference

International Partners Support Group: a continuing role for UNDP

At the Geneva conference, it was decided to create an International Partners Support Group (IPSG) “to assist Pakistan develop concrete plans and projects and help secure financial and other commitments of support for the implementation of these plans and projects over the coming years.” UNDP agreed to provide the Secretariat for the IPSG, which has subsequently met three times. Beyond its value to support the implementation of plans and initiatives stemming from the 4RF, and importantly to inform donors of progress, the IPSG is the only forum for a broad development policy dialogue between the Government the development partners – at least since 2017. With support from KfW, UNDP is supporting preparation of a comprehensive M&E Framework for the 4RF, including developing capacities to ensure transparency, accountability and equity as well as the involvement of local communities in the reconstruction process.



UNDP's crisis response: SURGE coordination

SURGE plan

Key features of the SURGE plan were (1) emphasis on recruitment of national experts (as also recommended by the RC), (2) a deliberate strategy of placing advisors with federal and provincial governments, with the dual aims of supporting Government and positioning UNDP for downstream implementation of Government and loan-funded programming, and (3) a programming framework for UNDP's initial response. There was some discussion about whether the Pakistani members of the SURGE planning mission were overly dependent or trusting of the Government and getting UNDP too close to domestic politics, but on the whole the benefits of country knowledge, access and prior relationships outweighed any disadvantages.

The SURGE plan was comprehensive and detailed. The approach was sound and showed that a SURGE plan is more of a direction-setting tool (for strategy, themes and immediate HR resourcing) than a blueprint.

The SURGE plan was somewhat optimistic on resource-mobilisation and timelines. In retrospect the SURGE plan overestimated the operational needs, miscalculated the RCO willingness to engage on the nexus, and overpromised on Gender Equality and on the "integration of risk reduction and disaster resilience into all activities." However, these observations have the benefit of hindsight. The plan and recommendations were very reasonable given the information available at the time, and the timeframe of the mission.

Two key elements of the SURGE plan were not fully implemented: appointment of a senior SURGE Coordinator, and a recommended management and reporting structure for the SURGE team.

Coordination of the response and the SURGE deployees

The goal from the SURGE plan was to "ensure the institutionalization of recovery interventions within the office architecture, minimizing silos and standalone implementation structure and promoting programme coherence."

In theory the SURGE team was integrated, but in practice the SURGE team worked in a bubble: initially a free-floating bubble within the office, and later a bubble attached to the RECCU. The SURGE team working on flood response and the RECCU staff were managed by the same ARR, but only coordinated structurally at weekly Flood Task Force meetings chaired by the RR. Also, there were few SURGE team meetings, so even SURGE team members were not structurally linked to each other (just ad hoc linkages). Despite being seated in the same open area, and instances where deployees and CO staff worked on special projects together, the SURGE deployees were not really working together as one team on one plan.

There are two reasons for this. First, the siloed and hierarchical nature of the office meant that there was a lack of appetite at all levels to brainstorm and strategise collectively in ways that capture the benefits of each unit. There was no forum or impetus to do this.

But more importantly, there was a succession of SURGE coordinators whose reporting relationships were not very clear. SURGE coordinators were first a senior CB deployee, then officially the ARR but de facto an Early Recovery deployee double-hatting, then a senior RBAP deployee. Over time, reporting relationships also shifted: the RR, DRR, ARR or SURGE team coordinator would take the lead on different issues, and sometimes the SURGE team would communicate directly with the CB or RBAP without involving the CO.

The SURGE team made good use of their MS Teams space, but this is not connected across to the CO's Sharepoint system, and as a result ended up becoming a separate SURGE Information Management system.



UNDP's response: financing and deployments

Financing: \$1,403,500

Crisis Bureau has provided resources in three baskets:

- \$500k: quick-release programmatic funding in the amount recommended for an L2 response
- \$150k: for technical consultancies (of which \$121,500 was used for PDNA, 4RF and related deployments)
- \$753,500: for the remainder of the deployment costs, including the Delivery Lab mobilisation

Deployments: 47 deployees (24M and 23F) – 21 SURGE/staff and 26 ExpRes/consultants

As recommended by the SURGE plan and the RC, deployments had a distinctly national character. 5 of the international staff deployees were of Pakistani origin, and there were 17 national deployees and 2 UNVs: so altogether, 24/47 or 50% of all deployments were Pakistani, and predominantly male (17M/7F). However, the overall **deployments were gender-balanced**.

Given the need for rapid turnaround on assessment and recovery planning, it was imperative to rapidly identify and recruit national experts. They were recommended by UNDP and partners. Some of these experts did not always draw on innovative and up to date thinking and examples.

8 of the national consultants (5M/3F) were deployed to support the federal and Sindh provincial governments. Some of these were reportedly officials on leave (introducing a potential conflict of interest), and in the end it is not clear what was the quality and value-added of the 8 Government deployees. Whilst the CO had oversight on consultants' deliverables, there were limited opportunities for regular supervision and communication.

There was an overall sense across the AAR interviews that **deployments are a more valuable use of scarce Crisis Bureau resources than programme seeding**, but even then, the deployments need to be timely (subjective score 8/10), high quality (9/10), led by demand (8/10), and well-managed at CO level (7/10), in order to be fully effective.

PROs and CONs of using primarily national experts from the old guard.

PROs: quick and relevant. Nationals know the country, have good personal contacts, are immediately available (no travel or visas required), are culturally and politically aware, and possibly lower cost (?).

CONs: less able to bring in experience from other situations, less likely to think outside the box, more male, more process-oriented and risk-averse (carrying Pakistani bureaucratic habits), and increased risk of conflict of interest. Can find it hard to get elbows out with Government.



UNDP's response: financing and deployments

ExpRes roster:

In Pakistan, there were 26 ExpRes deployments: 10 international and 16 national. The large number of national deployments demonstrated that the **ExpRes roster is a highly effective way of bringing experts on board quickly**. However, since national consultants were not on the roster prior to the response, UNDP should consider the following risks for future responses:

1. Additional pressures on the ExpRes team to arrange for rapid technical vetting, BSafe and PSEA training
2. Concerns about quality, as the expedited process for a pre-identified candidate **could** skip several QA steps
3. Concerns about the fiduciary and performance risks **if** the same people in the CO identify the consultant, develop the TORs, approve the selection, supervise the work and approve payments
4. Concerns about the accelerated recruitment of targeted candidates **potentially** affecting the long-term integrity of the ExpRes roster

Delivery Lab: 2022 Delivery Lab Annual Report observations about UNDP operations globally:

1. Lack of agile, flexible, and responsive recruitment SOPs to facilitate hiring in time-sensitive crisis settings
2. Lack of adequate planning and monitoring mechanisms
3. Inability to identify personnel with then required risk tolerances to fit various situations and cultural contexts
4. Lack of digital know how and accessibility

Delivery Lab in Pakistan:

Team Leader and six technical experts deployed in 2023 to address operations bottlenecks in the Pakistan CO. Regarded by the CO as highly relevant, agile, and cost-effective (mostly on part-time remote deployments that allow flexible accompaniment over a longer period). Funded from the Crisis Bureau SURGE budget, although their mandate is not directly related to the flood response.



UNDP's response: deployee satisfaction

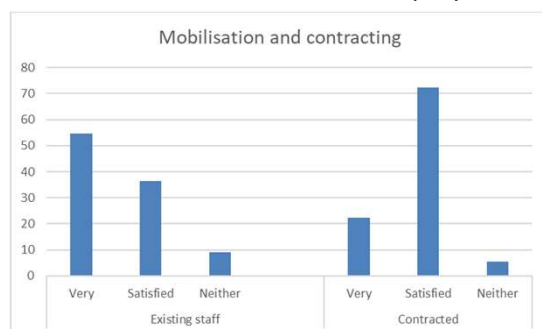
Survey results (31 complete responses from 46 requests).

None of the responding deployees thought the assignment could have been done well if it were done remotely.

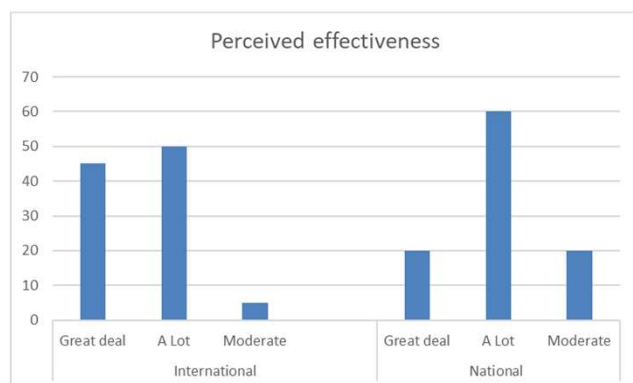
Deployee satisfaction was high regarding the deployee mobilisation/contracting as well as onboarding/country briefing, and still high but a little more mixed regarding the clarity of the mandate and TOR's deliverables. Functional supervisors were nearly always identified, but contact with the supervisor was somewhat less frequent. Assignments were self-assessed as very effective, and 60% deployees provided a handover briefing or exit report (40% did not).

Overall, the survey suggests, as expected, that deployees (notably those deployees who answer online surveys) had a good overall assignment in terms of recruitment, supervision and overall performance. See Annexe 4 for details

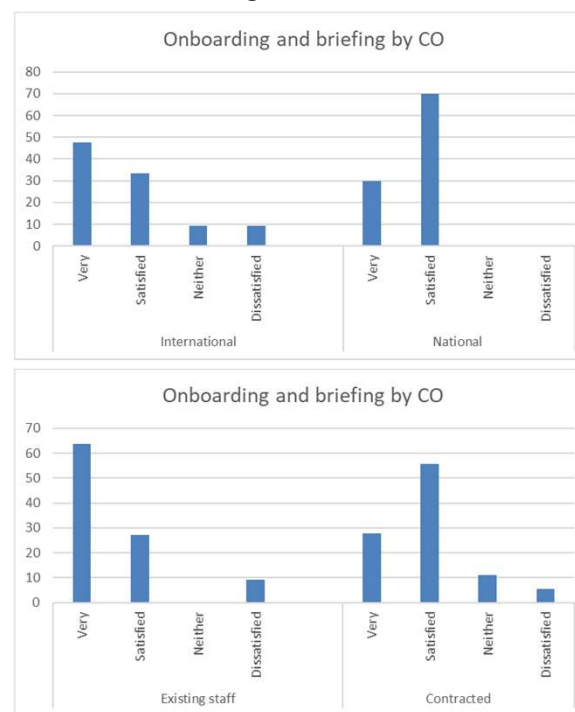
Existing staff had a slightly better experience with mobilisation than contracted deployees



Perceived effectiveness was slightly higher among international deployees than national deployees



Existing staff and international staff had a slightly better experience with onboarding than contracted and national staff



All graphs show percentages of respondents. Caution: very low *n* values = low reliability of comparative conclusions from survey data, so trends shown here are very approximate



Communications

Early communications:

An international communications staff member of Pakistani origin was available in country (while he was on leave), and mobilised in 24 hours to support the existing national comms team.

The comms team got out quickly. Several early videos of the RR, and also voices from across the UNDP offices, were developed immediately, with the focused message that “damage is severe : climate change is a factor : early recovery is needed soon : UNDP is there.” This was not so much a pitch to mobilise resources for UNDP, nor information for Pakistani nationals, but it was instead aimed at strategic positioning of UNDP in the minds of the donors and Government officials.

In the early weeks, field travel was difficult because of permissions (Baluchistan) and/or logistics (Sindh). Also UNDP did not have any activities in the field to show until December (Taraqee Foundation). So during the key first 90 days UNDP was able to capture strong interviews with global media but was not able to show examples of UNDP in recovery action.

In the absence of examples to show, and without a clear resource-mobilisation strategy (see later discussion), communications were of high quality but did not connect with resource-mobilisation, nor show real examples of recovery.

Seven phases of communications as the response progressed

- 1: Immediate visibility with messaging about the recovery needs and UNDP being engaged
2. Roll-out of the PDNA and highlighting UNDP’s role as a core member and convenor of other UN agencies
- 3: UNDP’s Flood Recovery Vision, with UNDP’s 4 pillars of response (carried through into mid- and late-stage resource-mobilisation)
- 4: Visuals from the field projects started to be broadcast in November (Taraqee Foundation, and Islamic Relief project signing)
- 5: Geneva conference: a huge effort of comms involving well-coordinated efforts from RBAP, Geneva, HQs and the CO as UNDP was supporting all conference communications on behalf of the SG. In this period, communications for UNDP itself were somewhat eclipsed
- 6: Post-conference positioning of UNDP’s Flood Recovery Program and Pakistan’s recovery efforts, although the overall comms effort cooled in early 2023 as the SURGE team drew down. At this point there were two comms tracks within the CO: a Pakistan recovery track (PDNA, 4RF, Donor Conference and IPSG), and a separate UNDP track highlighting the Flood Recovery Program
- 7: Coming soon, expected round of communications as the Japan project becomes operational - the first (and so far only) substantial UNDP project for flood response





U N

D P

Communications

Communications impact:

Communications were strong. The RR was regarded as being interested, available, quick and smooth on camera, and the CO team reported strong support from BERA and RBAP. Altogether there appears to have been a strong comms team conducting plenty of appropriate comms activity: quality videos, frequent social media posts, appropriate talking points for events and meetings, quality presentations etc. However, whether the activity was successful is harder to measure.

One clear success was the initiative to profile a repurposed China project. This pre-floods Chinese project was adapted to flood response, and then profiled in a short video. Until this video, the staff in the Chinese embassy (and presumably in Beijing) had never really seen their project in action - and this pitch was credited with mobilising the Chinese embassy to recommend a further round of support to UNDP.

One clear missed opportunity was the initial round of \$500k provided by the Crisis Bureau, and divided between two NGO projects. The projects were in themselves successful (see later discussion), but they did not connect up to communications and resource mobilisation for three reasons: (1) they were relatively late to start up and to show results (the Islamic Relief project began 3 months after the crisis, in December), (2) there was no clear resource mobilisation strategy for them to connect with, and (3) they were not designed from the bottom up with resource-mobilisation in mind.

It is generally assumed that the early-release TRAC 3 project funding from UNDP is intended to jump start programming, and to help strategic positioning and resource mobilisation, by demonstrating that UNDP can deliver and by showcasing scaleable activities. However, in three previous AARs, we have looked at this early programming and found that it is always too late (Lebanon, Maria/Irma, Mozambique), and/or a disproportionate effort for the CO to deliver in relation to the development and institutional benefits (Mozambique, Maria/Irma), and/or too difficult to replicate and scale up (Lebanon). In none of these instances has this early project funding really achieved its strategic and resource-mobilisation goals.

In order to achieve these greater benefits, COs need to select activities and partners with communications and scaleability in mind from the start – there needs to be a deliberate communications-supported feedback loop from the project design through implementation to resource-mobilisation. The activities can be good small-scale recovery (as they were in Pakistan), but, even more important than their inherent quality, they need to be effective vehicles for communications and resource-mobilisation. And to help achieve all this, this greater strategic result, COs might benefit from some targeted support from the Crisis Bureau.



Resource mobilisation for UNDP : the plan

UNDP's ambitious resource mobilisation plan:

The very first program outline prepared by the CO, approved on 6 September 2022, was for \$ 18M over 18 months. In retrospect, this first outline was the most realistic and practical, and seems to have been the most locally-informed.

However, it was rapidly replaced by a more ambitious SURGE plan, that was later fleshed out in great detail in the PRODOC for the Flood Recovery Program, and through which UNDP hoped to raise \$ 90M over 24 months (\$ 30M for the first six months, followed by \$ 60M in the next 18 months). The CO and the SURGE team recognised that this was ambitious, but together decided to press ahead. In retrospect, it might have been wiser to aim for a more modest programme, building up slowly and stretching out over 5 years (the timeframe of the 4RF). Perhaps this gap between the perspectives and expectations of the SURGE team and CO partly underlay the lack of clarity and possibly even muted commitment to resource mobilisation.

In the end, the CO deployed four different resource-mobilisation strategies:

0. In a stage zero, at the humanitarian moment, UNDP did not seek humanitarian funding (in the view of the AAR, see earlier discussion, this was the correct decision)
1. Early Recovery: in the first three months, UNDP softly pitched several donors, and landed successfully with Japan and to some extent with China (see later discussion)
2. The central strategy in this early period was to secure a share of the IFI loan funding, and there were high expectations of UNDP being the Government's chosen partner for implementation of a \$100M loan package
3. Recovery: after the IFI route turned out to be unsuccessful (see later discussion), efforts after the Geneva conference returned to bilateral donors who had indicated interest in Geneva: notably Germany, and secondarily Korea, France and Canada. This initiative is still under way, albeit still rather softly. More Chinese funding is also a possibility here
4. Build on established partnerships: stemming in part from the work of the sector working groups put in place for the 4RF, UNDP is currently coordinating the development of three Joint Programmes (initially four – shelter has been dropped) in education, governance, and livelihoods. While these have the advantages of building on established programs with agreeable partners and established donors, the linkages to flood recovery are in some cases rather tenuous, and the prospects of donor funding seem quite remote



U N
D P

Resource mobilisation for UNDP : the result

One year on: **there is no definitive list of what was provided to and by UNDP for recovery.** There are several estimates, ambiguous attributions, and unclear numbers. No single entity is responsible in the CO for bringing the programming and funding information all together: because of the aforementioned silos, the SURGE team under RECCU does not have perfect line of sight across all units, and reporting is not systematic

Best estimate of how much UNDP has actually allocated for flood recovery: \$ 30.4M

\$ 10M, made up of \$ 6M of new funding (incl \$ 1.3M from UNDP itself), plus \$ 4M of repurposed projects

Japan: \$ 4.63M – the first and only, all-new, large-scale, purpose-built flood response project

UNDP CB funding:

- \$ 500K of UNDP TRAC 1.1.3 funding divided between 2 NGO projects
- \$ 150K of UNDP TRAC 1.1.3 funding allocated for studies and local consultants
- \$ 750K for SURGE deployment costs (including the Delivery Lab)

Repurposed projects: For repurposed projects, for the most part donors reached out directly to their counterparts in UNDP – it was not so much a case of UNDP having a coherent plan and going out to donors. As a result, the repurposed projects are somewhat fragmented, and even now hard to pull together the full picture. In general, repurposed funding was relatively low because of the poor geographic fit between UNDP's regular program (emphasising KPK, Baluchistan, and Gilgit/Baltistan) and the locations of the floods

- \$ 80K from a Canadian education project to rebuild a flood-damaged school in KPK
- \$ 300K from a UK/USA governance project, used for risk aware planning and coordination in Sindh
- \$ 650K from a UK elections project (adapted to issue NICs to women who had lost their NICs in the floods)
- Approx. \$ 2.0M of repurposed USAID funding across about 5 projects
- Approx. \$ 1.0M (2 x \$ 500k) repurposing of pre-flood China projects (COVID response and Livelihoods)

Hard pipeline: \$ 20.4M

China: \$ 1.5M + \$ 2.2M – both projects at advanced stages of approval and building on 2 earlier China projects

UN Habitat: \$ 2.7M (imminent: this is a UNDP procurement contract to rescue a struggling UN Habitat project)

KfW: \$ 14M (advanced design stage: new project to provide monitoring and technical support for the 4RF)



Resource mobilisation for UNDP's Pakistan response: why was it not so successful?

Donors speak of good communications and engagement of RR and DRR – but this did not convert into funding. There are several likely contributing factors to this:

1. Most stakeholders (including the RR) feel that **UNDP simply did not place enough emphasis on resource mobilisation** for UNDP – that support for the PDNA-4RF-Geneva conference and the Government took most of the CO's available bandwidth. Between the unstoppable pressure to meet Government and SG deadlines, and the more malleable desire to raise funding, fund-raising always got pushed to second place
2. Resource-mobilisation was not well-coordinated from the start. Initially each unit was pursuing its own resource-mobilisation discussions with its known donor partners: there was no overall plan and leadership push, and scattered effort. "Reliance on personal networks is how things get done in Pakistan but that also created gaps and blind spots if it is not all managed." With no **single resource mobilisation focal point in the CO to pull it all together**, and no clear leadership of the SURGE team, there was no strategic vision of which donors to prioritise and why/how, informed by an understanding of the donor priorities and their respective funding cycles. In essence, there was no planned and managed campaign
3. There were three experienced resource-mobilisation experts deployed in sequence (with uneven handovers between them), but they were **tasked with preparing proposals rather than planning and leading engagement** with the donors
4. Geneva was supposed to kick off the recovery round of resource-mobilisation (after the humanitarian phase), but bilateral donors proved to be generally unresponsive. This was not for lack of good programming ideas – but rather because **Pakistan was (and still is) a genuinely difficult bilateral donor environment**. Some donors have long planning cycles and little flexibility off-cycle (USA, UK, EU), several donors are experiencing cuts (USA, UK, Canada), some donors have rigidly pre-determined target sectors or regions (Canada, EU), and some have preferred partners (for example the EU preference for Team Europe). But most of all, there is a prevailing donor ambiguity about Pakistan, partly due to geopolitical considerations relating to Pakistan's relationship with Afghanistan, perceived human rights challenges, Pakistan's standing as a middle-income country and the expectation that "donors should not be doing more for Pakistan than Pakistan is doing itself," compounded by concern about Pakistan's defense spending relative to SDG priorities
5. Some UNDP stakeholders think that UNDP could/should have done more at the Geneva conference to mobilise resources for UNDP, but others close to the conference are convinced that there was not the institutional or political space for this
6. UNDP miscalculated their approach to the IFIs (see later discussion)
7. It is possible that some CO programming teams were hesitant to pursue new funding and new commitments on top of already-full workloads, especially if the perceived effort to funding ratio was unfavorable

In summary, the **donor environment was not at all conducive**. UNDP could have done better, could have been better organised/strategic than it was – following a resource mobilisation plan and less ad hoc. But **basically, UNDP did the right things for resource-mobilisation, and was always unlikely to get much funding in this donor environment**



Resource mobilisation: recipe for success?

The ideas below are a paraphrased summary of several conversations with deployees:

1. Get a team fully dedicated to respond to the crisis (not part-time, or distracted by their other work, and this can be a combination of CO staff and deployees). Getting the A-team in place quickly is essential.
2. In the CO, need to have a clearly aligned office with strong leadership. Get the UNDP Regional Director to visit and have an all-staff meeting to get everyone behind the same goal.
3. Ensure there is one strategy for the response and for resource-mobilisation, led by a person with the authority and/or ability to coordinate and guide all the CO units (program and operations).
4. Put in place a dedicated resource-mobilisation team, empowered to follow, track and engage over a longer period, with a view to build up relationships. Invest in understanding the priorities and cycles of all major donors. Include in the team a capacity to develop quality proposals quickly, so the team can adapt to the expectations of different donors with short deadlines.
5. Deliver quicker, “we are too slow and heavy”. Either we need to streamline our processes, or have more people and systems in place to support delivery with our existing processes.
6. Take risks and be bold. Do not be afraid to fail. Try something new – be explicit about the risks, and mitigate those risks by documenting it as a pilot.



Resource mobilisation for UNDP: what we heard from IFIs

Why did the IFI strategy not succeed?

UNDP placed 8 advisors with ministries and provinces, as a deliberate strategy (outlined in the SURGE plan) to strengthen capacity and position UNDP for loan funding. These were generally valued by Government (although details are sparse), but did not provide leverage for loan funding – despite an approved PC1 from the Planning Ministry naming UNDP as preferred partner for one component of a World Bank loan.

Loan funding did not follow for 7 reasons (4 are more generic/global, and 3 reasons are contextual/local):

Global factors

1. **UNDP could not show a technical comparative advantage** to the IFIs or to the Government (unclear business case for UNDP, and some sense that UNDP is spread too thin – “following the money” and lacking depth anchored to an identified comparative advantage)
2. **UNDP overheads seen as too high** (by the Government and the Banks), since UNDP turns around and contracts NGOs or other agencies anyway (with another layer of overhead) (perceived higher cost)
3. Some concern that **UN reporting** follows UN annual cycles and **does not always meet IFI’s reporting needs**
4. **Weak institutional relationship between UNDP and IFIs at HQs, and in country** (although UNDP and ADB have a charter/MOU that allows quick approval: ADB sees an agreement with UNDP not as a procurement action but as the activation of an existing umbrella agreement)

Local factors

5. **UNDP was too late**: if UNDP is not named in the IFI’s early design stage and written into the appraisal report (design was done in October 2022 and approved December 2022) then there is less chance to become the implementing partner (misunderstood IFI process)
6. **UNDP never actually asked**. “UNDP tried to get into the side door but never knocked on the front door.” Reportedly, the RR never directly asked the WB Representative if UNDP could be an implementing partner
7. **Right skills sets**. the deployees did not have adequate experience and skills sets to build a relationship with the Bank

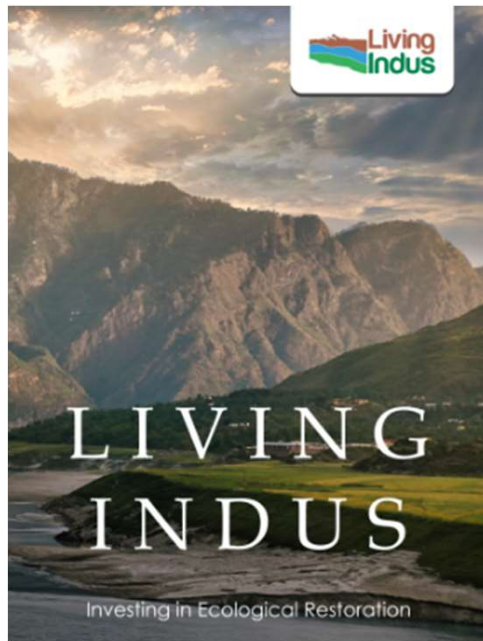


Resource mobilisation for UNDP: what we heard from Government

The comments below summarise what Government wants from the UN system as a whole (not specific to UNDP)

Federal

1. Less overhead, and more direct funding to the people (also affects perceptions of UNDP as an implementing partner for loans)
2. A transparent program that is aligned with the national budget (on-plan), supported by a robust M&E framework, so that Government and the public can see the results and the VfM
3. Adopt a local approach – spend through Pakistani accounts (helping the Balance of Payments) and procure locally. Ensure that programs benefit the local economy



Provincial (Sindh)

1. More assistance with resource mobilisation for Sindh
2. More technical support for the development of strong projects (PC1s)
3. Research that is more policy-centred and less academic
4. Better gender analysis and gender integration
5. “UNDP is great on workshops and seminars,” but GoSindh also wants more practical support
6. Support for the “Living Indus” initiative



UN
DP

Programmatic response: the initial 500k

The overall approach to the initial NGO projects was “classic early recovery.” The activities were drawn from the menu offered by prior early recovery training and by the Crisis Bureau’s Crisis Response Packages: emergency livelihoods (micro enterprise regeneration), cash-for-work aimed mainly at housing reconstruction, cash grants for extremely vulnerable households, and community infrastructure (especially WASH). These activities were appropriate to the context, and familiar to the implementing agencies. One project started quickly (Taraqee Foundation in Baluchistan), and the other took 3 months to get started (Islamic Relief in Sindh): so UNDP could have been quicker in Sindh.

Both projects were highly effective, targeted vulnerability, achieved gender participation targets, and provided excellent VfM. However, they were identical to the activities of these organisations funded by a wide range of donors, and they showed **no particular UNDP value-added**. In the cold light of day what they showcased is that UNDP can fund good early recovery by NGOs, just like any donor.

The only innovation reported was that, after the two projects were over, the comprehensive but rather dry final reports were complemented by a dialogue with the implementing organisations (called “listening sessions”). In these dialogues UNDP staff were able to hear more about the implementation challenges and how they were overcome, and got a better feeling for how the projects behaved and evolved. These discussions were reportedly oriented more towards learning than accountability. This would seem to be a good practice, but unfortunately the sessions were managed by the SURGE team and the ACC LAB, and were not documented, so in the end it is not certain if or how there was a connection to the CO or impact on future work.

Although the two projects were framed as pilots, the “piloting” aspect and the connection to future work did not happen – not for UNDP (the IRP project in Sindh did influence downstream work of other donors – see below). Indeed, despite the success at the field level, most of the piloted elements (cash-for-work, cash for small enterprise, shelter construction) were actually blocked from the Japan project (see later discussion). **Ironically, the \$ 500k projects successfully proved a project concept that the preferred donor (Japan) and UNDP’s own procurement and construction regulations would not allow the CO to replicate.**



One-room house rehabilitated by IRP in Sindh

The IRP project in Sindh reportedly developed a model for a simple one room house, involving a preferred construction plan, a kitchen area, and community-led construction paid through cash installments directly to the owner (thereby reducing corruption risk). The model was adopted by the World Bank and the Government of Sindh to be scaled up province-wide and implemented by a Government-owned company Sindh People’s Housing Foundation. While one-room houses were also widely adopted after the 2010 floods, the innovation in this case seems to be the linkage to rehabilitated community facilities especially WASH, the community-led cash modality, and the issuance by the Government of ownership certificates to houses that are compliant with the model and built on improved flood-resistant platforms. The cash approach is also perceived to empower the affected people and stimulate the local economy – and is regarded as more effective and efficient than contractor procurement or in-kind procurement, which are slower, more expensive and still provide no guarantee of success. 36



Programming: repurposing projects

Overview of repurposing

Approximately \$ 4M was repurposed to address the floods, from about 10 existing projects. Every programming unit of the CO including the Policy Unit's SDG program made some contribution through repurposing. In most cases, the idea for repurposing came from the donor, so in that sense it was supply-driven, rather than designed and managed by UNDP in a more holistic way.

Repurposing has PROs and CONs. Beyond the public relations benefits to the donor and to UNDP, and the actual results of the new activities, repurposing can allow a project to reset and refocus if it is drifting, or it can soak up some underperforming or underutilised resources. However, on the CON side, repurposing can take more effort and time to negotiate with a donor than the corresponding benefits, and if a project's resources are fully allocated to well-performing activities, then liberating resources for recovery can displace results from another area with no net gain (and an overall burden of transactional work).

Crisis modifiers: an idea whose time has come

Crisis modifiers are a way of financing disaster risk, and are especially well-suited to situations with large-scale development programmes, but which also face known sudden-onset disaster risks. In essence, crisis modifiers are contingency mechanisms built into development projects that allow rapid funding in response to an anticipated crisis, with very light, quick or local approval processes.

“There are three typical crisis modifier designs ... (i) pre-approved budget reallocation mechanisms at the programme or at the project level; (ii) fast-track access rules allowing access to a third-party humanitarian donor providing rapid external liquidity inflow; or (iii) contingency funds held as reserves at the programme or project level.” ([OPM report on Crisis Modifiers](#)).

Crisis modifiers have been used since at least 2013. The UK has led the way in developing the approach, which is also being used by the EU (ECHO), USA and the World Bank. Other donors such as Australia, Canada and Germany are aware of the mechanism but might not yet have tested it.

UNDP has much to gain from requesting crisis modifiers, in any context where there is a high risk of a natural disaster. At best, existing projects could obtain additional or rapid reallocation of funding when a sudden onset disaster is triggered. At the very least, even if a crisis modifier is not approved, UNDP would demonstrate to donors that it is deliberately assessing and managing risks.

BERA saw no reason why crisis modifiers should not be included in project financing agreements, but discouraged the idea of reopening framework agreements. The precedent would be the way that UNDP introduced PSEA clauses into financing agreements, using model clauses that were agreed by a consensus of donors.



Programming: Flood Recovery Program

The FRP is a well put-together plan that hits all the right buttons and demonstrated coherence with all relevant strategic frameworks.

Programme Pillars	4RF Strategic Recovery Objectives	UN Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework for Pakistan 2023-2027	UNDP Strategic Plan Outcomes 2022-2025	CPD 2023-2027 Outputs
Pillar 1: Housing and Community Infrastructure	SRO4: Restoring Basic Services and Infrastructure	Outcome 1: Basic Social Services	Outcome 3: Resilience built to respond to systemic uncertainty and risk.	Output 2.2: Access to basic services and financial and non-financial assets and services improved to support productive capacities for sustainable livelihoods, jobs, employability for youth, girls/women, and other vulnerable groups.
Pillar 2: Livelihoods Recovery	SRO2: Restoring Livelihoods and Economic Opportunities	Outcome 6: Sustainable inclusive economic growth and decent work	Outcome 1: Structural transformation accelerated, particularly green, inclusive, and digital transitions.	Output 2.2: Access to basic services and financial and non-financial assets and services improved to support productive capacities for sustainable livelihoods, jobs, employability for youth, girls/women, and other vulnerable groups.
Pillar 3: Restoring Government Services	SRO1: Improving Governance and Capacities of the State	Outcome 5: Governance	Outcome 2: No-one left behind, centring on equitable access to opportunities and a rights-based approach to human agency and human development	Output 1.4: People and institutions equipped with strengthened digital capabilities and opportunity to contribute to and benefit from inclusive digital societies.
Pillar 4: Disaster Resilience and Environmental Protection	SRO2: Restoring Livelihoods and Economic Opportunities	Outcome 3: Climate change and the environment	Outcome 3: Resilience built to respond to systemic uncertainty and risk.	Output 3.2: Efficient and sustainable use of ecosystems including the Indus Basin, for resilient communities through interventions for improved health, livelihoods, green economy and green energy.



Programming: Flood Recovery Program: 2 donors so far

China: generally a good news story

Support from China has generally been strong. From two pre-existing projects that UNDP was able to adapt to include some flood response, UNDP then developed two follow-on projects that build on early successes and go further into flood response. Note that these two new China projects are being managed by different units of the CO, possibly inviting some coordination challenges. On the horizon, there is some hope of a larger more structural program with China.

1. Pre-flood project: focus on COVID, public service capacity, school renovations and health equipment, with some repurposing for flood response (CPRU) \$ 2.0M (of which maybe \$ 500K repurposed for flood response)
2. Also pre-flood project: focus on livelihoods, including agriculture inputs and tools. No cash. Started recently and repurposed to include some flood response (CPRU) \$ 1.5M (of which maybe \$ 500K flood response)
3. Recently submitted, second phase of #1, focus on flood-affected areas (CPRU) \$ 1.5M
4. First true flood response proposal, MSME support, also recently submitted (RECCU) \$ 2.2M
5. New proposal for \$ 20M program now being discussed with CO Beijing

Japan: less of a good-news story

The Japan project took six months to move from concept to approval, and a further six months to begin operations. Part of the delay was on the Japan side, because the funding was only ever going to be available in March. But several other reasons on the Government and UNDP sides conspired to extend this to September 2023.

12 Sept 2022: detailed concept note for 4.984M (to start after March 2023)

26 Nov 2022: detailed PRODOC for 4.629M (to start January 2023)

Jan-Mar 2023: Ops deployee worked almost exclusively on Japan procurement (NGO selection process) that was overturned and restarted in April

March 2023: revised project agreement signed with Japan

15 Aug 2023: partner is contracted, bids for UNDP procurement are ready to advertise, first tranche requested, but no implementation started yet

Reasons for the delay

1. RBAP/BRH disagreed with cash transfers for micro-enterprises: instead requested in-kind contributions based on enterprise-specific needs assessment
2. RBAP/BRH disagreed with the planned shelter approach (community-based construction through a cash modality), and instead requested site-by-site infrastructure feasibility studies, and procurement of a construction company according to construction guidelines (see later discussion)
3. Japan and BRH both disagreed with cash for work, or any kind of cash grants in this project (preferring in-kind distribution)
4. CO management and the procurement unit disagreed with IP doing procurement (prefer procurement to be done by procurement unit not the IP)
5. GoP changed policy on transitional shelter, so this shelter component was suspended and then reprogrammed into solar and other activities

In the end: due to UNDP, Government, and donor restrictions, mostly stemming from risk-aversion, the proposed approach has been changed dramatically. The “piloted” ideas were not considered acceptable to scale up, and **the final project is both more admin (procurement) intensive for UNDP, and slower to implement.**



Programming: looking ahead

KfW

New proposal, in tandem with the UK, for \$ 14M, to support implementation of the 4RF. KfW is reportedly contemplating whether there is enough momentum behind the 4RF and IPSG to proceed. Government regretted that it was not consulted earlier in the development of the project (apparently this was sprung on the Government by the donors at the second IPSG meeting). The proposal could but does **not appear to contain any component to monitor and report on gender equality in the implementation of the 4RF: missed opportunity.**

UN Habitat

Reportedly, UNDP is to be engaged as the procurement agency by UN Habitat to help rescue a struggling education project

Joint Programs

Three joint programs are under development, in livelihoods, education and governance. If all three proceed, then a challenge in Pakistan will be how to coordinate three separate joint programs working with the same provincial Governments in the same districts. And a coordination challenge within UNDP will be how to manage 3 different but related JPs from three different programming units of UNDP.

Green Climate Fund

There is some hope that Green Climate Fund resources could be received from Government, pending Government review.

UAE

UNDP is reportedly in early discussions with the UAE about whether a project announcement could be made in the context of COP28

Where is resilience?

The SURGE plan promised that “specifically, UNDP will support the integration of risk reduction and disaster resilience into all activities to address underlying climate change risks and protect communities against floods in the future”, and the FRP proposes “a systemic set of interventions which improves the well-being of communities affected by crisis, seeking to build resilience, and strengthening their capacities to adapt and recover.”

Review of the project documents reveals that the **attention is mostly on recovery and little on resilience.** One small component of the repurposed programme (UK project in governance sector) did specifically focus on developing risk frameworks for 3 vulnerable districts in Sindh, and this could become a model for risk-aware planning and coordination, for Sindh and other provinces, but would need to be scaled up through a new project.



Gender equality plans and strategies

GE in the analysis

In the immediate recovery period – there were references to gender-based violence in most of the context analysis, and reference to women as a particularly vulnerable population: for the most part women were described as victims rather than agents of recovery and change. Women and girls were described in a rather classic humanitarian way, as a target population, falling short of the empowering and leadership ideals of the IASC policy on gender in humanitarian action, or UNDP's Ten Point Action Agenda on Gender in Crisis.

GE in the programme frameworks

UNDP's SURGE plan was somewhat light on gender equality, proposing the appointment of a SURGE gender advisor (to our knowledge not implemented). The FRP tantalisingly suggests that "recovery and stabilization solutions offer significant scope to jump-start structural changes, reset negative social norms and open opportunities for women's full and equal participation in economic life", but provides no specific strategy to achieve this. These observations are consistent with the results of the 2021-2023 UNDP Gender Seal assessment, which remarked that progress had been made by the CO, but suggested that much more still needs to be done (also without actually suggesting a way to do this).

Despite the lack of disaggregated baseline data, the UNDP-supported PDNA and 4RF both recognised longstanding gender inequities and the challenges of reaching women and girls especially in the most conservative regions but did not propose courses of analysis and programming intervention aimed at having a gender transformative impact. The 4RF talks of being "gender-informed and community-led" and "gender-sensitive recovery" but it remains to be seen how this will translate into practice (recall that 96% of the external 4RF funding is loans, half of which have no relationship to the floods at all). To date, nothing in the downstream documents (i.e. the planned 4RF monitoring framework or the Government's early reporting to the IPSG) shows evidence of gender transformative goals or activities.

In discussion with Government, there was no encouragement for the idea that the IPSG could become a forum for policy dialogue between donors and Government on gender questions. On this topic, there was clear signal that gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls is regarded by officials as bundled with culture and religion and regionality and domestic politics – and that enthusiasm for the IPSG would evaporate if discussions led in this direction.

GE in deployments

As was observed earlier, there was a good aggregate gender balance across all the UNDP deployments, with a majority of women in the international deployments offsetting a majority of men in the national deployments. It was observed that more female international staff would be attracted to long-term deployments if UNDP were willing to make small but practical accommodations to allow female deployees to bring infant children on their assignments.



Gender equality in programming

GE in UNDP programming

The PRODOC has the required annexes with a gender analysis and action plan that promises “gender mainstreaming and empowerment of women and girls as cross-cutting themes”, and that implies future work along those lines, but again falls short of proposing a gender transformative approach (for example, ensuring that “at least 25% of the budget is invested in gender transformation” as promised in the CPD). But it is early days, so the CO still has ample opportunity to deepen their work on gender empowerment as the program is put into place.

UNDP has so far initiated three projects that respond specifically to the floods: the two NGO projects funded from the initial \$ 500K Crisis Board allocation, and the Japan project. All three projects were gender-screened and compliant, scoring GE2 or GE3, but in these projects also there does not seem to have been an effort to be gender transformative, even when women are expected to be at least half of the direct beneficiaries. The CO is cognisant of the challenging patriarchal and conservative contexts in which flood recovery programming is taking place, and aims at designing and implementing culturally-sensitive recovery interventions in its downstream response work.

One repurposed project deserves a notable mention: the \$ 300K reallocation from the democracy programme to support women to obtain National Identity Cards seems to have significant potential to empower women, as it conveys democratic and property rights that these women would not otherwise have.

The bright light in the gender equality landscape is the rather bold proposal by the Governance unit to develop a Joint Program with UNWOMEN and UNFPA that aims to be truly gender transformative, deliberately tackling negative social gender norms and SGBV by working with the Government security agencies to enable them to identify and respond to instances of bias, exploitation and abuse. The JP is not yet fully developed and is far from approval and funding, but seems to be a firm step in the direction of meeting the CPD’s outcome 4.

30. To *leave no one behind* and *build resilience*, UNDP will target sectoral gaps and socio-economic vulnerabilities, which increased during the pandemic, especially for women, girls, and transgender and other marginalized groups. It will apply a gendered cross-cutting approach in the other thematic outcome areas to ensure that women, girls and trans people are not just beneficiaries but genuine agents and leaders of change at all levels. From the 2023-2027 Pakistan CPD



U N

D P

Operational response

Overall: the response did not have major operations challenges

The SURGE plan anticipated problems with staff recruitment (bottleneck in the GSSC) compounded by staff vacancies throughout the operations units. It was reported by several stakeholders that staff were being bled away from UNDP to other agencies due to UNDP's uncompetitive NPSA salary structure. In retrospect, there might have been a big problem if the recovery had scaled up quickly as initially hoped, but fortunately (for the operations team) the rapid scale-up never came, potential bottlenecks in recruitment were worked around by using the ExpRes roster (see earlier discussion), and the operations team was able to keep up with the demand.

Thinking ahead

Even though the CO's operations capacity was sufficient – it would have been challenged if UNDP had succeeded in its goal of positioning itself at the centre of a program response. If UNDP intends to seek a central programming role in a future crisis, it would be wise to plan for that contingency and prepare an operations scale-up plan, for example by pre-identifying locally available operations consultants who can be surged in on short notice.

Positive impressions of the GSSC and Delivery Lab

Stakeholder impressions of the GSSC were rather positive. It was reported that senior staff in the GSSC were available and responsive, and that the GSSC gave quick turnaround when needed. The drop-down menu for L2/L3 crises in the GSSC portal meant that crisis-related requests went straight to a manager for assignment and fast-tracking. In the end, the CO did not ask much of the GSSC, and the GSSC delivered well.

As mentioned earlier, the work of the Delivery Lab was also appreciated. The team expertise was seen as very appropriate and timely, and very responsive to CO's specific needs – "solution-oriented".

Information management: unfinished business

Information management is a challenge in the Pakistan CO, as in most COs. On the one hand, the SURGE deployees made good use of a shared Teams folder (appropriate since some deployees do not have undp.org accounts). Nevertheless, electronic information is not being managed systematically, and too much time is spent looking for documents that are not filed in an organised way, or that were created by people who have left the office. In the context of a SURGE response, there are two particular problems. First of all, files created by Expres deployees in their personal accounts are deleted when their assignment ends and their accounts are deleted, unless these documents are saved to a Teams or Sharepoint folder. The second issue is that the Teams channel created by the SURGE team, and used extensively until the end of 2022 and to a lesser extent since then, is not connected to the office's Sharepoint system. As a result, there are now two parallel systems in use: Sharepoint mainly by staff, and Teams mainly by deployees. These need to be consolidated into Sharepoint.



Perspectives
from survey
respondents-

“we need the operational infrastructure that supports accelerated delivery – but we do not have this.”

“Our bureaucracy in general is not well-suited to crisis: our organisational architecture is built for long-term structural support to Governments, not for quick response.”

Operational response: managing risks

Procurement

Two observations were made about procurement. The first, reported here without much substantiation because we did not seek to meet the procurement team to discuss this further, is the perception that the procurement processes in the CO are heavier and more bureaucratic than necessary, with an emphasis on compliance over risk management. An example provided is that the procurement unit preferred that UNDP itself carry out procurement within the Japan project, rather than delegate this to the NGO partner, on the assumption that UNDP would get better value for money (which might be true, but does not factor in the increased admin load for UNDP, or the lost development benefits of delayed delivery). Another example might be the reported reluctance of the CO to use Responsible Party Agreements. The second observation is that the CO could be making more use of the LTAs of other UN organisations (under the mutual recognition principle). Following a recommendation from the SURGE Team, the CO has established an NGO roster to facilitate quick engagements in crisis situations.

Construction: a possible Achilles Heel for UNDP's recovery work

In many UNDP crisis responses, there is a shelter or housing program, sometimes also a component of rebuilding Government offices or facilities like clinics and schools. The projects reviewed in previous AARs had such components, (Caribbean, Mozambique, Lebanon), and were all implemented prior to the adoption in June 2020 of UNDP's construction works policy.

After a lengthy review and approval process for the FRP PRODOC, it was determined that UNDP would not undertake community-led construction using the model proposed (and followed previously in Pakistan), where UNDP would provide resources (cash and/or materials) to the community, for the community to use in their own construction work. Instead, the determination (following the construction policy) was that there must be verification of land title, a feasibility study, an engineering inspection and validation of the design, and an independent firm contracted to undertake the construction. These steps are not practical for a recovery project that aims to build several thousand one-room housing units spread over a large region, and quickly.

The construction works policy seems to be entirely appropriate for major construction – the problems seem to be that (a) there is no materiality threshold in the policy – the policy as drafted would seem to apply to works of any size and there is no provision for minor works, and (b) it applies equally to any aspect of work: “all the activities associated with the construction, reconstruction, demolition, repair or renovation of infrastructure or activities such as site preparation, excavation, erection, building, installation of equipment or materials, decoration and finishing.” A literal reading of the policy would suggest that every individual one-room shelter is its own “work” needing its own assessments, and that even repainting a wall is “works” covered by the policy, although it seems most unlikely that is the intent of the policy.

In the end, the CO abandoned the idea of community-led shelter reconstruction, partly because of these procurement determinations, and also because the Government changed its policy. However, this remains a point of great vulnerability for UNDP's ability to respond to a natural disaster, and clarification or amendment of the construction works policy, specifically to provide a lighter pathway for small-scale works, would seem to be required if UNDP is ever to work in small-scale shelter again.



Recommendations



To the Country Office

Recommended immediate actions regarding the 2022 Floods

- The UNDP Pakistan CO should consult with key stakeholders (Government, donors and development agencies), and **decide where to take the IPSG**
- The UNDP Pakistan CO should assess whether the **new KfW project** has seized every opportunity to include gender equality as a dimension of performance assessment and technical support to the 4RF, and negotiate project enhancements with KfW and stakeholders
- The UNDP Pakistan CO should **transfer key information the SURGE team's document folders into the CO Sharepoint**, and close the Teams channel so all 2022 floods response information is appropriately archived and accessible to CO staff

Recommendations for next time

- Assign a **senior manager to coordinate the SURGE** team and the response, and ensure that there is continuity in that position
- Assign a **gender advisor** from the start in order to shape every aspect of the response from deployments, through assessments, to advocacy and programming
- **Avoid setting up a parallel Information Management system** - use an existing office system
- Use available **other agency LTAs** as much as possible



U N

D P

To the Country Office

Preparing for next time

- **Re-engage with the HCT**, participate regularly, and seek a visible role in the HCT's discussions on anticipatory action and prevention. Some areas where UNDP might have a comparative advantage in prevention could be climate change adaptation, land use planning, land registry and building codes
- Consider what are the two or three most likely sudden-onset emergencies that the country might face (possibly floods, earthquake, and conflict) and use this **scenario planning** to inform CO preparedness
- In consultation with BERA, pilot the inclusion of a **Crisis Modifier** clause in a financial agreement, preferably with the UK or USAID (most likely to be receptive). The ideal project for this pilot would be one in a region and sector that are susceptible to flood or earthquake risk
- Based still on the emergency scenarios, pre-establish a **crisis response team** in the CO: a small core group with designated roles, and with questions of command structure, coordination and resources worked out and consolidated through a simulation exercise
- This small crisis response team would further enhance the crisis preparedness capabilities of the CO by **promoting cross-team collaboration and information sharing**, thus breaking down silos within the office
- Consult the Crisis Bureau on training available through the **Crisis Academy**, and plan a basic training cycle to be delivered over the next year to a wide range of CO staff. Plan for a more advanced and targeted (possibly tailored) training package to be delivered to the CO crisis response team, in a shorter timeframe
- Based on the emergency scenarios, identify and prequalify a **national roster of experts** who can be called in when needed
- Considering the likely activities that UNDP would be carrying out in a range of probable situations, develop **strategic relationships with a small number of well-qualified national NGOs** (i.e., meet regularly, designate focal points, share information, and develop a model financial agreement – in advance of a crisis)
- In the next Business Continuity Planning cycle, develop a **contingency plan for scaling up Early Recovery** in response to the most likely crisis scenario, and include this as an annex in the BCP
- Consider how the CO can **meet its Gender Equality commitments** in a future response, notably the empowering and leadership dimensions of UNDP's Ten Point Action Agenda on Gender in Crisis, and be ready to **assign a gender advisor** to support the response from the earliest stage
- Review other agency LTAs in Pakistan, to be more ready to **use other agency LTAs** to accelerate procurement



To the Crisis Bureau

Crisis preparedness

Strategic positioning

- Ensure that recent HQs strategic thinking on UNDP's role in a sudden-onset crisis (e.g., latest revision of the SOPs) is pushed out to Regional Bureaux and crisis-prone COs, so that they are up-to-date on the latest CB approaches, SOPs and tools
- Keep engaging with other UN agencies on Anticipatory Action, which is emerging as an alternate locus of nexus thinking

Crisis readiness of senior staff

- In response to demand from Regional Bureaux, provide targeted training to senior field staff on how to operate in humanitarian contexts (the HCT and the Humanitarian Program Cycle, cluster system, HDP nexus, RPBA/PDNAs etc)
- This could be part of deployment training for DRRs and RRs, possibly through the Crisis Academy, although RRs and DRRs need something more concise, adapted and leadership-oriented



To the Crisis Bureau

Crisis response

Crisis modifiers (see page 39 for explanation):

- Work with all Regional Bureaux to **pilot a crisis modifier arrangement** in each region, choosing a likely country, using Crisis Bureau funding to design and test, aiming to show how it could work before scaling up

SURGE

- **Field a senior SURGE coordinator right away** – and keep this position filled - to both manage the SURGE deployments and also to coordinate the country Response Plan. Ensure this person is well-connected to the CO structure so that the SURGE becomes a support to the CO not a new stand-alone entity that later has trouble integrating with the CO when the SURGE winds up.
- The SURGE planning mission should automatically be a **scoping mission for the Delivery Lab**
- At the end of the SURGE, draft a **SURGE exit plan** for review and approval at a final meeting of the Crisis Bureau

Field-level handover and continuity

- Require CO-level response team meetings to have summary minutes and to save them all in the CO's Sharepoint system (vital for handover and continuity)
- Require all deployees to provide an end-of-assignment summary, or a Handover Note, or a Back to Office Report, and to file this in the CO-level Sharepoint



**To all
Regional
Bureaux**

Improve crisis readiness of senior staff

- If UNDP intends to be relevant in the crisis space, then senior managers in crisis-prone countries should be mandated by Regional Directors to see crisis response and recovery as a core function. This could be part of deployment training for DRRs

Address procurement and operations capacity bottlenecks

- In Crisis situations, actively encourage COs to use other agency LTAs
- Ensure adequate supplemental operations capacity in COs responding to crisis

Pilot crisis modifiers (see page 39)

- Pilot crisis modifiers in a major program country susceptible to predictable risks, use Crisis Bureau funding to design and test, show how it could work before scaling up
- Start with an easy country and easy issue (e.g., typhoon in Philippines, flood in Pakistan or Bangladesh) and work up from there

Contingency planning

- Ensure that counties at risk of a sudden-onset crisis undertake appropriate contingency planning, including programmatic and operational preparedness

Risk management culture change

- Encourage COs and Regional Bureaux staff to think more about risk-informed decision-making than compliance. Broaden the scope of Risk Management from an operational focus to a strategic focus, with more emphasis on managing the reputational risk of the organisation's relevance and image in country, and reducing overcompliance

Delegate more authority to capable COs

- COs that meet corporate performance benchmarks should be rewarded with more decentralised decision-making to improve responsiveness



To other UNDP Bureaux

To BMS

- Continue to improve operations systems (procurement, HR) so they can match the requirements and expectations of flexible rapid action in crisis (being adaptive, recognising not “business as usual”, agile)
- Modify the June 2020 procurement policy for construction to allow a lighter or different approach for low dollar-value and community-led works. Otherwise, UNDP cannot do any of the usual quick infrastructure rehabilitation (community infrastructure, road repair, government building repair, transitional shelter etc) that are recommended recovery activities by the Crisis Bureau. Two issues need urgent clarification: what are “works”, and what is the \$ 200K threshold: \$ 200K per “work” or for “all works” in a project?

To BERA

- Support a pilot to introduce crisis modifiers into the funding arrangements for a crisis-prone country in each region



Annexes

Methodology for Data Collection

Travel to Pakistan and supplementary Teams interviews

Total Level of Effort: 25 days

Workplanning: 2 days

Document review: 3 days

Interviews: 7 days

Field travel: 7 working days in-country

Report drafting: 6 days

Key Stakeholder Interviews (n = 65)

UNDP staff (n = 38)

Local partners, including private (n = 2)

Other UN agencies (n = 3)

Government officials (n = 4)

Donors & development banks (n = 6)

Deployees (n = 12)

Review of relevant UNDP and related documents (n = 128)

UNDP documents

- Crisis Board and CMST
- SURGE
- Mission reports
- PDNA
- 4RF
- Programme documents

HRPs and related humanitarian documents

Media reports

Interviewees

UNDP CO	samuel.rizk@undp.org
UNDP CO	knut.ostby@undp.org
UNDP CO	Aliona.niculita@undp.org
UNDP CO	amir.goraya@undp.org
UNDP CO	otgontsetseg.zundui@undp.org
UNDP CO	mustafa.mahmood@undp.org
UNDP CO	Tabinda.Anwar@undp.org
UNDP CO	javeria.masood@undp.org
UNDP CO	liu.wen@undp.org
UNDP CO	kaiser.ishaque@undp.org
UNDP CO	syed.sabeeh@undp.org
UNDP CO	syeda.memoona.zeb@undp.org
UNDP CO	anita.bakhtiar@undp.org
UNDP CO	ammara.durrani@undp.org
UNDP CO	mary.cummins@undp.org
UNDP RBAP	Keshini.wijesundera@undp.org
UNDP RBAP	shakeel.ahmad@undp.org
UNDP RBAP	claire.van.der.vaeren@undp.org
UNDP RBAP	violet.baffour@undp.org
UNDP RBAP	tshering.pem@undp.org
UNDP RBAP	bernardo.cocco@undp.org
UNDP HANOI	khusrav.sharifov@undp.org
UNDP BERA	janil.greenaway@undp.org
UNDP BERA	raofarrah@yahoo.com

UNDP CB	Devanand.Ramia@undp.org
UNDP CB	Rebecca.Reynolds@undp.org
UNDP CB	saumik.de@undp.org
UNDP CB	rahulpandit@undp.org
UNDP CB	subodha.kuruppuarachchige@undp.org
UNDP CB	janthomas.hiemstra@outlook.com
UNDP CB	george.conway@undp.org
UNDP CB	rita.missal@undp.org
UNDP CB	usman.iqtidar@undp.org
UNDP CB	usman.gazi@undp.org
UNDP CB	Sanny.jegillos@undp.org
UNDP CB	fabio.oliva@undp.org
UNDP CB	barbara-anne.krijgsman@undp.org
UNDP CB	Joana.sampainho@undp.org

WB	atehsin@worldbank.org	Deployee	sitara.syed@undp.org
ASDB	asif@adb.org	Deployee	shirazalishah@hotmail.com
		Deployee	nasir.hussain.pak@gmail.com
RCO	julien.harneis@un.org	Deployee	lady-pokolo.andrewson@undp.org
OCHA	chatora@un.org	Deployee	ccnaumann@yahoo.com
OCHA	henrys@un.org	Deployee	pia.hansen@undp.org
		Deployee	Hamza.Hasan@undp.org
Canada	luke.myers@international.gc.ca	Deployee	dany.oliveira@undp.org
EU	Ovidiu.mic@eeas.europa.eu	Deployee	andra.brige@undp.org
USA	ragrant@usaid.gov	Deployee	maria.hasan@undp.org
UK	sandra.baldwin@fcdo.gov.uk	Deployee	marta.lanzoni@hotmail.it
		Deployee	tomoki.matsuura@undp.org
GoP Plan	Tassaduq Hussain Jadoon		
GoP EAD	Anita Turab		
Go Sindh	Safia Amir		
Go Sindh	Raja Masroor		
Taraqee	essa@taraqee.pk		
IRP	raza.narejo@irp.org.pk		